Moving to Central Florida

Real numbers on insurance, taxes, fees and timing, so nothing about the house surprises you after you move.







Windermere, on the lakes southwest of Orlando. Right: Horizon West at sunset, and Clermont.

Four numbers to know

$2,000–4,000

Home insurance a year in Orange, Seminole and Osceola. The roof's age moves it most.

$1,000–3,000

CDD fee a year in many newer communities, on top of the HOA.

January 1

Own and live in the home by this date to claim homestead for that year.

30–45 days

A typical Florida closing. Remote and mail-away closings are routine.

The two that catch buyers off guard

Insurance. The scary statewide headlines come from coastal South Florida. Orlando sits more than 45 miles inland, so premiums here run well below the state average, and a home with a young roof lands near the bottom of the range.

CDD fees. A Community Development District fee repays the bonds that built the roads and amenities in many newer communities. It runs for 20 to 30 years and is billed on the property tax bill, so listings rarely mention it. Ask for the tax record before you make an offer.



Winter Garden, on the lakes west of Orlando

What the monthly payment really includes

Principal and interest — Lender quote
Your mortgage payment.

Property taxes — County tax estimator
Reset at the price you pay, not the seller's old bill.

Home insurance — Insurance quote
Usually $2,000–4,000 a year here. Roof age moves it most.

Flood insurance — FEMA flood map
Required only in higher-risk zones. Optional in Zone X.

HOA — HOA documents
Varies by community, from modest to a few hundred a month.

CDD — County tax record
On the property tax bill in many newer communities.

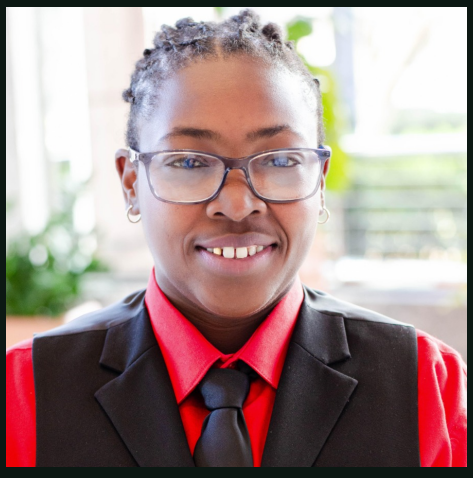
Questions buyers ask

Is this home in a flood zone?
Standard home insurance does not cover flooding. Most of inland Orlando is low-risk Zone X, where flood coverage is optional and inexpensive. Check the zone before you make an offer.

Are the schools good, and how do we check?
Schools are assigned by exact address, not by city or zip code, and they can change from one street to the next. Check the assigned schools for every home you are serious about.

When should we close to get the homestead break?
You must own and live in the home by January 1 and file by March 1. If you are moving late in the year, aim to close in the fall.

What about hurricanes?
Storms weaken quickly over land, which is why insurance costs less inland. Newer homes are built to strict wind codes, and a wind mitigation inspection can lower the premium.



Thinking about Florida? Call me before you start looking. I will connect you with a Central Florida agent I trust.

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Tashira Clark, Realtor, Keller Williams Realty, Atlanta, Georgia. Figures are 2026 estimates for Orange, Seminole and Osceola counties and vary by home, roof age, coverage and community. Sources: Florida Office of Insurance Regulation, county property appraisers, FEMA. Not legal, tax or insurance advice.